NETFLIX GLOBAL TOP 10

Prioritizing promotion opportunities for Netflix

From viewing trends to earlier-season promotion
Evidence from 24-week launch observations

Data analysis portfolio

BUSINESS QUESTION & APPROACH

Viewing trends guide promotion test priorities

BUSINESS QUESTION

Which promotion opportunities should Netflix prioritize testing to increase total weekly viewing hours?

FOCUS

Why focus on TV?

Compare TV and film viewing hours, then English and non-English TV, within the Top 10 data.

TIMING

When to test?

Count older seasons in the Top 10 each week from 12 weeks before to 11 weeks after launch.

SEASON COVERAGE

Which seasons?

Compare 24-week Top 10 weeks per season: the immediately previous season versus earlier seasons.

Business objective: incremental total weekly viewing hours. Top 10 patterns identify hypotheses for testing.

DATA INTRODUCTION

Dataset overview

10,960
weekly chart records

274
reporting weeks

4
content categories

Format	English	Non-English
Film	Top 10 each week	Top 10 each week
TV	Top 10 each week	Top 10 each week

Coverage: 4 Jul 2021 to 27 Sep 2026. Each reporting week ends on Sunday.

DATA INTRODUCTION

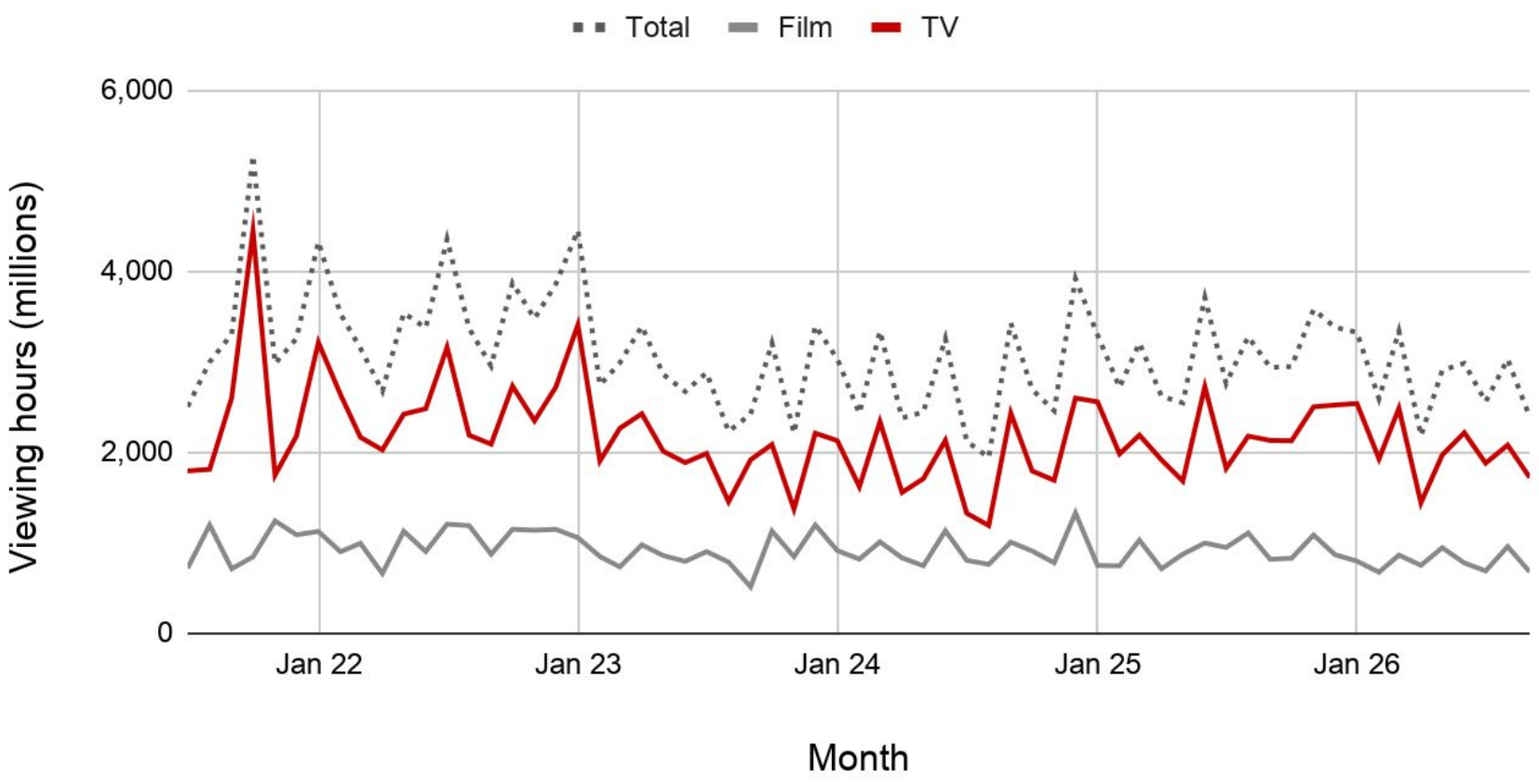
Metrics and TV data coverage

Field	Meaning	Role in this analysis
weekly_hours_viewed	Listed weekly viewing hours	Background context
weekly_views / runtime	Views and content duration	Coverage starts in June 2023
cumulative_weeks_in_top_10	Lifetime chart weeks, including returns	Background context
Derived weekly chart presence	1 = listed, 0 = absent from a complete chart	Main outcome

5,480 TV records across 274 reporting weeks

Chart absence means below the observed Top 10 threshold. It does not mean zero viewing.

TV generates about 70% of observed Top 10 viewing hours



≈70%

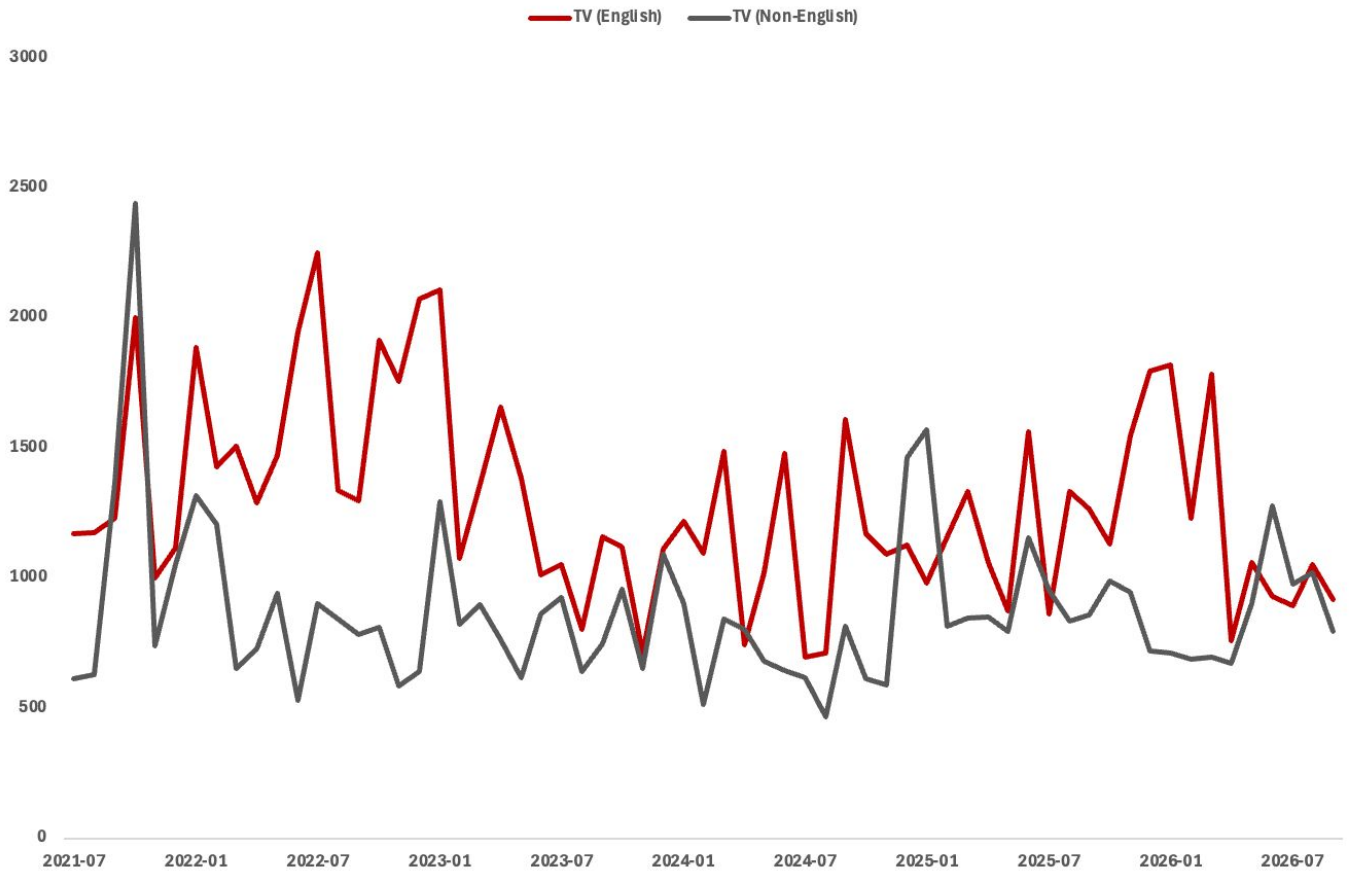
Annual TV share

Year	TV share
2022	71.0%
2023	70.2%
2024	67.2%
2025	71.1%

TV's share makes it a priority area for promotion research.

Source: Netflix Top 10 data; share of observed TV + film hours, not all Netflix viewing. Monthly totals contain four or five report weeks.

Non-English growth did not offset English TV's decline



Annual Top 10 viewing hours (bn)

Category	2022	2025	Change
English	20.16	14.91	−26.0%
Non-English	9.95	11.34	+14.0%
Total TV	30.11	26.25	−12.8%

Change from 2022 to 2025

English TV: −5.25bn hours
Non-English TV: +1.39bn hours
Net TV change: −3.86bn hours

Source: Netflix Top 10 analysis. Annual changes compare full 2022 and 2025 totals. Monthly chart hours are in millions.

PROMOTION OPPORTUNITY: EARLIER SEASONS

Use launch windows to explore earlier-season promotion

Release format	Complete events	Distinct series	Event–older-season pairs
All at once	4	3	5
Split batches	6	4	16

10 launches across 6 distinct series in total

Count older-season Top 10 listings by week relative to each new-season launch.
Compare weeks listed for the previous season versus earlier seasons.

Each event is a new-season launch. Group totals use different sample sizes and cannot rank release-format effectiveness.

24-week observation design

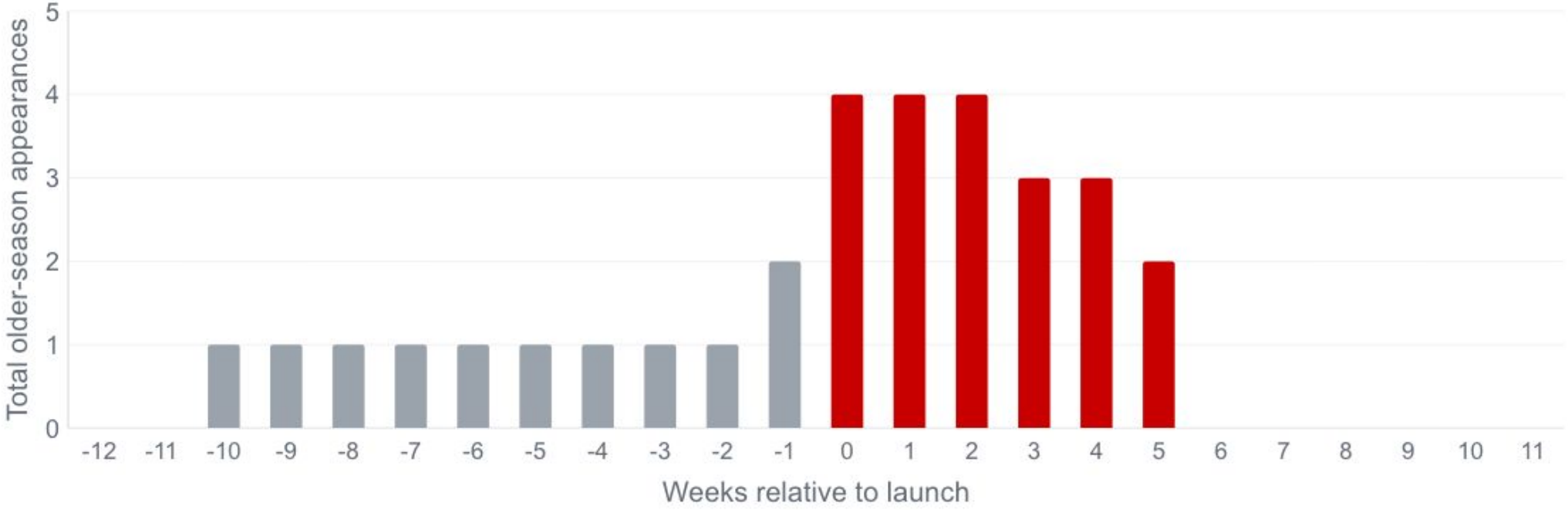
Element	Definition
Observation period	Week −12 through Week +11, inclusive
Week 0	Report week containing the first-batch release
Older season	A lower-numbered season from the same series
Weekly total	Count listed event–older-season pairs in each relative week
Coverage requirement	All 24 category charts contain ranks 1–10

One older season listed for one week = one season-week

Week 0 is the first release week. Later batches may affect listings; these patterns do not measure promotion effects.

Week −1: Top 10 activity expands beyond Ms. Rachel

Weeks −10 to −2: only Ms. Rachel S1 is in the Top 10.
Week −1: Squid Game S1 returns to the Top 10 ahead of S2's launch.

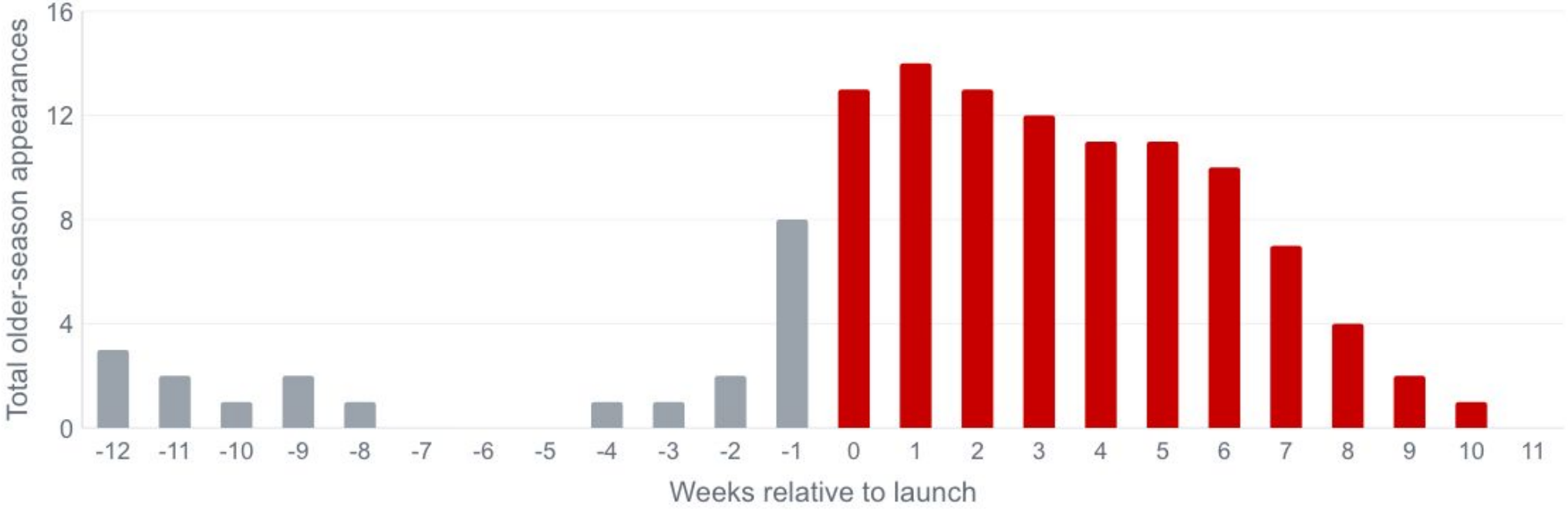


Next test: A/B test promotion in Weeks −1 to +5; this is a candidate window, not a proven optimum.

4 launches, 5 event–older-season pairs. Gray = before launch. Red = launch week onward.

Split batches: older-season Top 10 listings peak in Week +1

One week before first-batch launches, older-season Top 10 listings rise from 2 to 8.
Older seasons remain in the Top 10 through Week +10 across the sampled launches.



Next test: A/B test promotion in Weeks −1 to +7; this is a candidate window, not a proven optimum.

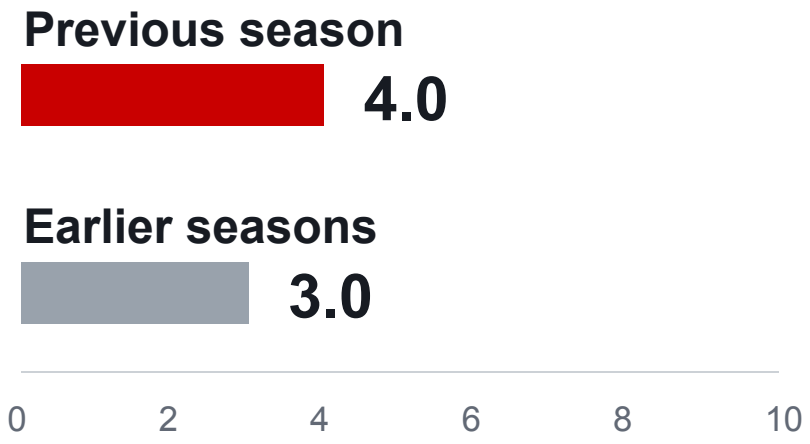
6 launches, 16 event–older-season pairs. Week 0 = first-batch launch week.

WHAT WE FOUND: SEASON COVERAGE

Small samples cannot establish which seasons to prioritize

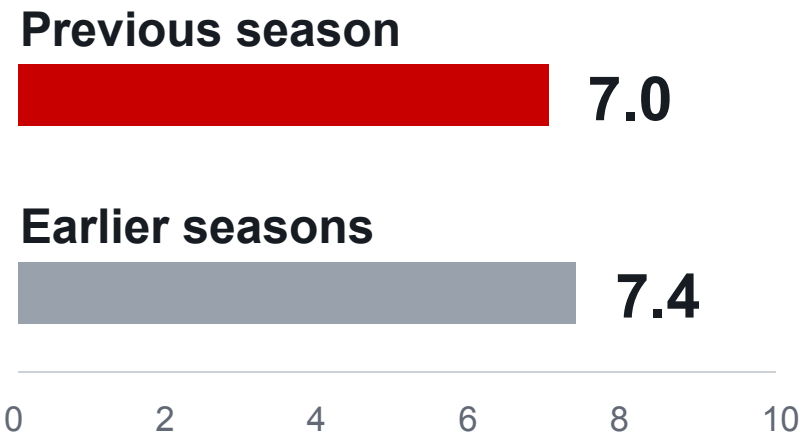
All at once

Mean number of weeks in Top 10 per season · 24-week observation



Only 1 event: Squid Game S3

Split batches



Only 5 events across 3 series

Next: Expand the series sample and use full viewing data, including seasons outside the Top 10.

Previous = immediately preceding season; earlier = seasons before it. Average seasons within each group, then weight launches equally.

Limitations and interpretation

Selected sample	10 selected new-season launches across 6 series; some series appear more than once.
Chart threshold	Viewing hours for seasons outside the Top 10 are not observed.
Release timing	Later episode batches and other events may affect older-season Top 10 listings.
Season comparison	Both season groups exist in only 1 all-at-once and 5 split-batch launches.
Interpretation	Top 10 listings cannot establish how much extra viewing a promotion would generate.

Candidate A/B test windows: −1 to +5 (all at once); −1 to +7 (split batches). Neither is an established optimum.

Earlier-season promotion: findings and implications

Launch timing	Older-season Top 10 listings rise in Week −1 in both release groups.
All at once	Listings peak at 4 in Weeks 0–2; none are observed in Weeks +6 to +11.
Split batches	Listings peak at 14 in Week +1; at least one remains through Week +10.
Season coverage	Too few events and Top 10-only coverage to establish which seasons to prioritize.
Promotion implication	A/B test candidate windows: −1 to +5 (all at once); −1 to +7 (split batches). Optimal timing remains unknown.

Counts sum event–older-season pairs. Different group sizes mean raw counts cannot compare release-format effectiveness.

Next steps for earlier-season promotion

CANDIDATE TEST WINDOWS

A/B test by format

All at once: Weeks −1 to +5.
Split: Weeks −1 to +7.
Test added older-season promotion versus business as usual within each format.

WHICH SEASONS

Broaden data coverage

Add more series and Season 3+ launches.
Use full weekly viewing data, including unranked seasons, to compare previous and earlier seasons.

BUSINESS OUTCOME

Test incremental impact

Within each format, randomly assign users to added promotion or no added promotion.
Compare weekly viewing hours per user across all content.

Candidate windows are selected from observed patterns. Lift versus business as usual does not prove optimal timing or compare formats.